

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To solve this problem , we need to analyze the patient's symptoms : persistent sadness , feeling that his life is cursed , difficulty making decisions , hope lessness , worsening suicidal ide ations , and guilt . The patient also mentions having less energy and concentration , which align s with depressive symptoms . He is otherwise doing okay and can maintain a job , indicating that he doesn 't seem to be in a psychotic state . Since the patient has at least a two -week period of worsening symptoms including suicidal ide ation , it suggests a major depressive disorder with potential for a depressive recurrence .

</thought>

< answer >

The patient is at risk for double depression .

A . The patient is at risk for double depression .</ answer >

Thought : This conclusion is correct as the symptoms suggest at least a previous episode of a depressive disorder , and now a current episode of a depressive disorder , which fits the criteria for a double depression (also known as a Major Depressive Episode with a prior Depressive Episode). Double depression means a person has had at least one previous major depressive episode and is experiencing a new episode of major depression with symptoms lasting 2 or more weeks . Option A aligns best with the described symptoms .</ answer >

